

ER

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ER: Requirements Specification Component

Creating a space where developers can quickly find accurate, reliable answers to their coding questions. What sets it apart is the community-driven approach, where users contribute their expertise, and the platform's voting and reputation system rewards quality contributions. We hope to create a self-sustaining cycle of knowledge.

A1: AskIT

AskIT is an online forum for developers share some doubts about programming languages, for example problems/bugs in a certain program.

The main goal of the forum is to allow anyone to ask their questions easily, so they can be helped by other users,and create a app where a user can easily find a solution to a problem even if they don't want to post a question, fostering a friendly community where users can get their issues or questions resolved. Our motivation to create a forum like this, is to give all users a safe place to share their doubts and knowledge

To interact with the community, users need to register or log in with a previously created account, which will allow them to ask and answer questions.Each user can share their own question or respond to others’ questions that appear in their personal feed. Within each thread, the author of the question can modify the tags and mark answers they consider correct. Each user has an associated score that is calculated considering the votes on its questions and answers.Registered users also have the ability to edit their profiles, view their and other users’ profiles, and recover their account credentials if needed.In profile section authenticated user can also view their questions and answers.

AskIT also organizes questions into tags, making it easier for users to browse or search by subject. The forum supports both exact and partial search queries of tags and doubts, enhancing the user experience by allowing flexible search options,an authenticated user can also choose recent or top questions to appear in feed.

Users are divided into groups: **administrators**, who can not only add questions and answers like all registered users but also have full access and modification privileges, like allowing them to edit or delete any content; **non-registered users(guests)**, who can only read the questions and answers posted by others and search for questions; and **registered users**, who can add new questions and answers, vote on answers, add comments, and search for existing questions, they enjoy a richer experience compared to non-registered users, allowing them to engage with the community and contribute to discussions;

References

A notable example is [Stack Overflow](#), as it implements the vast majority of the required features—search functionality (with filters, multiple attributes, tags, etc.), support for badges and a reputation system where users are assigned a score, the ability to mark an answer as correct ("accepted"), monitoring of questions/tags, and clear indications of edits made to questions/answers. Additionally, it also includes the features commonly found in Q&A sites related to account/profile management.

Other platforms in a more general context, meaning they are not limited to programming topics, include [Quora](#) and [Reddit](#). For example, on Reddit, after an account is deleted, user-related information (such as questions, comments, etc.) is retained. These two platforms also implement some of the features mentioned above, but they do not align as closely with the requirements as Stack Overflow does

A2: Actors and User stories

This artifact contains the specification of the actors and their user stories, serving as agile documentation of the project’s requirements.

1. Actors

For the AskIT platform, the actors are represented in Figure 1 and described in Table 1.

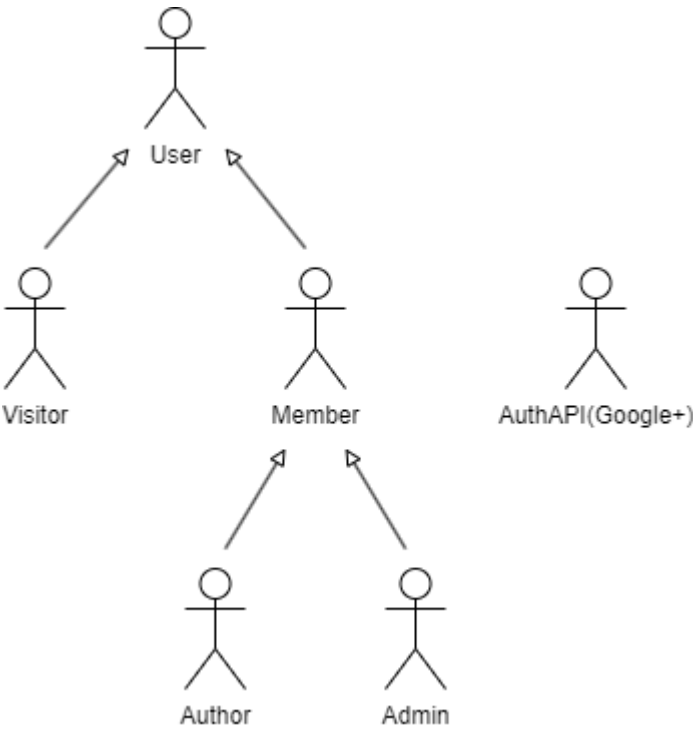


Figure 1: AskIT actors

Identifier	Description
User	Generic user with access to public content, such as questions and their answers, and view User profiles
Visitor	Unauthenticated user that can register or sign-in in the system
Member	Authenticated user that can actively participate in the platform by posting questions and answers, voting on content, commenting, following questions and tags, and viewing their own contributions. They also have access to a personal feed based on their interests
Author	Authenticated user that can manage their own content on the platform. This includes editing or deleting their questions, answers, and comments. Can also edit question tags and mark an answer as correct for their questions
Admin	Authenticated user responsible for user management, supervision and moderation functions in order to maintain the proper functioning of the community
AuthAPI(Google+)	External API, that can be used to register/log into the platform

Table 1: AskIT actor description

2. User Stories

User stories that should be considered for AskIT platform.

2.1. User

Identifier	Name	Priority	Responsible	Description
US01	View Top Questions	High	Diogo	As an user, I want to view the top questions so that I can see relevant topics
US02	Browse Questions	High	Daniel	As an user, I want to browse questions, so that I can find questions that interest me
US03	Exact Match Search	High	Rafael	As an user, I want to search with exact match keywords, so that I can find that type of content faster
US04	Full-text Search	High	Tiago	As an user, I want to do a full-text Search, so that I can find a specific content
US05	Search over Multiple Attributes	Medium	Tiago	As an user, I want to search over multiple attributes, so that I can refine my search
US06	Search filters	Medium	Rafael	As an user, I want to search with filters, so that I can restrict my search
US07	View Recent Questions	Medium	Daniel	As an user, I want to view recent questions, so that I can always be up to date on topics
US08	Browse Questions by Tags	Medium	Diogo	As an user, I want to browse questions by tags, so that I can find questions based on a specific theme
US09	View Question Details	Medium	Diogo	As an user, I want to view question details, so that I can understand the full context of a question
US10	View User Profiles	Medium	Daniel	As an user, I want to view other user profiles, so that I can check some details about the user, such as their post
US11	Placeholders in Form Inputs	Medium	Rafael	As an user, I want to have placeholders in form inputs so that I can understand what I need to put there
US12	Contextual Error Messages	Low	Tiago	As an user, I want to have contextual error messages, so that I can understand what caused the error
US13	Contextual Help	Low	Tiago	As an user, I want to have contextual help, so that I can use the app in an easier way
US14	About Us	Low	Rafael	As an user, I want to have a section "about us", so that I can know more about the web app

Identifier	Name	Priority	Responsible	Description
US15	Main Features	Low	Daniel	As an user, I want to have a "Main Features" section, so that I can understand what are the main goals
US16	Contacts	Low	Diogo	As an user, I want to have a "contacts" page, so that I can contact someone if I have a problem

Table 2: User user stories

2.2. Visitor

Identifier	Name	Priority	Responsible	Description
US17	Register	High	Diogo	As a visitor, i want to register, so that i can be a member
US18	Log in	High	Daniel	As a visitor, i want to log in, so that i can access to special features, only available to members

Table 3: Visitor user stories

2.3. Member

Identifier	Name	Priority	Responsible	Description
US19	Logout	High	Rafael	As a member,I want to logout ,so that my account stays safe
US20	View Profile	High	Tiago	As a member,I want to view profile ,so that i can keep my details up to date
US21	Edit Profile	High	Tiago	As a member,I want to edit profile ,so that i can keep my details up to date
US22	View Personal Feed	High	Rafael	As a member,I want to view personal feed ,so that i can see content based on my preferences
US23	Post Question	High	Daniel	As a member,I want to post a question ,so that i can have answers to solve my doubts/problems
US24	Post Answer	High	Diogo	As a member,I want to post a answer,so that i can help other users
US25	View My Questions	High	Diogo	As a member,I want to view my questions,so that i can track answers
US26	View My Answers	High	Daniel	As a member,I want to view my answers ,so that i can see if it helped other users
US27	Vote on Questions	Medium	Rafael	As a member,I want to vote on questions ,so that i can highlight the most useful ones
US28	Vote on Answers	Medium	Tiago	As a member,I want to vote on answers ,so that i can let other users know if it is useful
US29	Comment on Questions	Medium	Tiago	As a member,I want to comment on questions ,so that i can share some knowledge
US30	Comment on Answers	Medium	Rafael	As a member,I want to comment on answers ,so that i can provide feedback
US31	Follow Question	Low	Daniel	As a member,I want to follow questions,so that i can track a specific post
US32	Follow Tags	Low	Diogo	As a member,I want to follow tags,so that i can see what interests me
US33	Recover Password	Medium	Diogo	As a member,I want to recover my password ,so that i can have access to my account again
US34	Delete account	Medium	Daniel	As a member,I want to delete my account ,so that i remove all my data from the platform
US35	Support Profile Picture	Medium	Rafael	As a member,I want to have a support for profile picture ,so that i can personalize my account
US36	View Personal Notifications	Low	Tiago	As a member,I want to view personal notifications,so that i can be aware of my interactions

Identifier	Name	Priority	Responsible	Description
US37	Answer to Question notification	Low	Tiago	As a member,I want to receive “question answered” notification ,so that i can know if someone has interacted with my post
US38	Vote on Content notification	Low	Rafael	As a member,I want to receive “vote on content” notification ,so that i can know if my content is useful or not

Table 4: Member user stories

2.4. Author

Identifier	Name	Priority	Responsible	Description
US39	Edit Question	High	Daniel	As an author,i want to edit a question ,so that i can add some details to my post
US40	Delete Question	High	Diogo	As an author,i want to delete a question,so that i can remove content that is no longer important
US41	Edit Answer	High	Diogo	As an author,i want to edit a answer ,so that i can improve it or change some aspects
US42	Delete Answer	High	Daniel	As an author,i want to delete a answer ,so that i can remove it if it isn’t useful
US43	Edit Comment	Medium	Rafael	As an author,i want to edit a comment ,so that i can clarify my point
US44	Delete Comment	Medium	Tiago	As an author,i want to delete a comment ,so that i can remove it if it isn’t accurate
US45	Edit Question Tags	Medium	Tiago	As an author,i want to edit question tags ,so that i can change my tag if i make a mistake
US46	Mark Answer as Correct	Low	Rafael	As an author,i want o mark answer as correct,so that other know if it’s useful or not

Table 5: Author user stories

2.5. Admin

Identifier	Name	Priority	Responsible	Description
US47	Administer User Accounts	High	Daniel	As an admin,I want to search, view, edit, and create user accounts,so that i can manage each user account
US48	Administrator Accounts	Medium	Diogo	As an admin,i want to have administrator account ,so that i can manage the platform
US49	Block User Accounts	Low	Diogo	As an admin,i want to block user accounts ,so that i can act if an user has a bad behavior
US50	Unblock User Accounts	Low	Daniel	As an admin,i want to unblock user accounts ,so that i can let the user use the platform again
US51	Delete User Account	Medium	Rafael	As an admin,i want to Delete a user account ,so that i can remove problematic or inactive users
US52	Delete Content	Medium	Tiago	As an admin,i want to delete content that is inappropriate,so that we can have a good community
US53	Edit Question Tags	Medium	Tiago	As an admin,i want to edit question tags,so that i can change if it isn’t correctly categorized
US54	Manage Tags	Medium	Rafael	As an admin,i want to manage tags,so that i can create a well divided app

Table 6: Admin user stories

3. Supplementary Requirements

Visitor

Identifier	Name	Priority	Responsible	Description
US55	Log in with google +	Low	Daniel	As a visitor, I want to log in with google+, so that i don't need to spend a lot of time
US56	Register with google+	Low	Diogo	As a visitor, I want to register with google+, so that I can be faster with the entry of data

Table 7: Visitor extra user stories

Member

Identifier	Name	Priority	Responsible	Description
US57	Report content	Low	Diogo	As a member, I want to report content, so that i can report some abusive posts or answers
US58	Appeal for unblcok	Low	Daniel	As a member,I want to appeal for unblock, so that i can use the platform again
US59	Check Score	Low	Rafael	As a member,I want to check my score, so that i can know in what level am i

Table 8: Member extra user stories

3.1. Business rules

Identifier	Name	Description
BR01	Deleted Account	Upon account deletion, shared user data (e.g. comments, reviews, likes) is kept but is made anonymous
BR02	Admin as an User	Administrators are participating members of the community, i.e. can post or vote on questions or answers.
BR03	Edited Content	Questions and answers edited after being posted should have a clear indication of the editions.
BR04	User Score	User score are dependent on the votes received on his questions and answers, and also on actions made by the user. Question or answer is voted up: +10; answer is marked "accepted": +15 (+2 to acceptor); question or answer is voted down: -2; post is deleted by the admin: -100
BR05	User Own Content	User can't review or comment own posts, only other users can interact with that post
BR06	Dates	Any date, for example, publish date, edit date, comment date or even account deletion date, need to be higher than entry date(register)

Table 9: AskIT Business rules

3.2. Technical requirements

Identifier	Name	Description
TR01	Performance	The system should have an acceptable response time
TR02	Robustness	The system must be prepared to handle and continue operating when runtime errors occur
TR03	Scalability	The system must be prepared to deal with the growth in the number of users and their actions
TR04	Accessibility	The system must ensure that everyone can access the pages.Regardless of whether they have any handicap or not, or the Web browser they use, the AskIT platform should work any way
TR05	Web application	The system should be implemented as a web application with dynamic pages (HTML5, JavaScript, CSS3 and PHP). It is critical that AskIT system is easily accessible from anywhere and adopting standard web technologies.
TR06	Usability	The system should be simple and easy to use.AskIT should be a system that is easy to use from users of all ages.
TR07	Portability	The server-side system should work across multiple platforms

Identifier	Name	Description
TR08	Security	The system shall protect all information from unauthorized access
TR09	Ethics	The system shall protect all information from unauthorized access

Table 10: AskIT Technical requirements

3.3. Restrictions

Identifier	Name	Description
C01	Deadline	The system should be ready to be used at mid of December, to be able to start help people

Table 11: AskIT Restrictions

A3: Information Architecture

This artifact presents a brief overview of the information architecture of the system to be developed, it helps to identify and describe the user requirements.A sitemap helps to define how the information is organized in pages and wireframes to define the functionality and the content for each page.

1. Sitemap

AskIT is built with four main areas , Server Pages that are defined by the system and contain useful information for every user , User Pages responsible for register/login of users as well as viewing/editing their profile , Questions Pages allow the user/visitor to search and explore questions and the discussion section for each of the questions, and Admin Pages for administrators and their features.

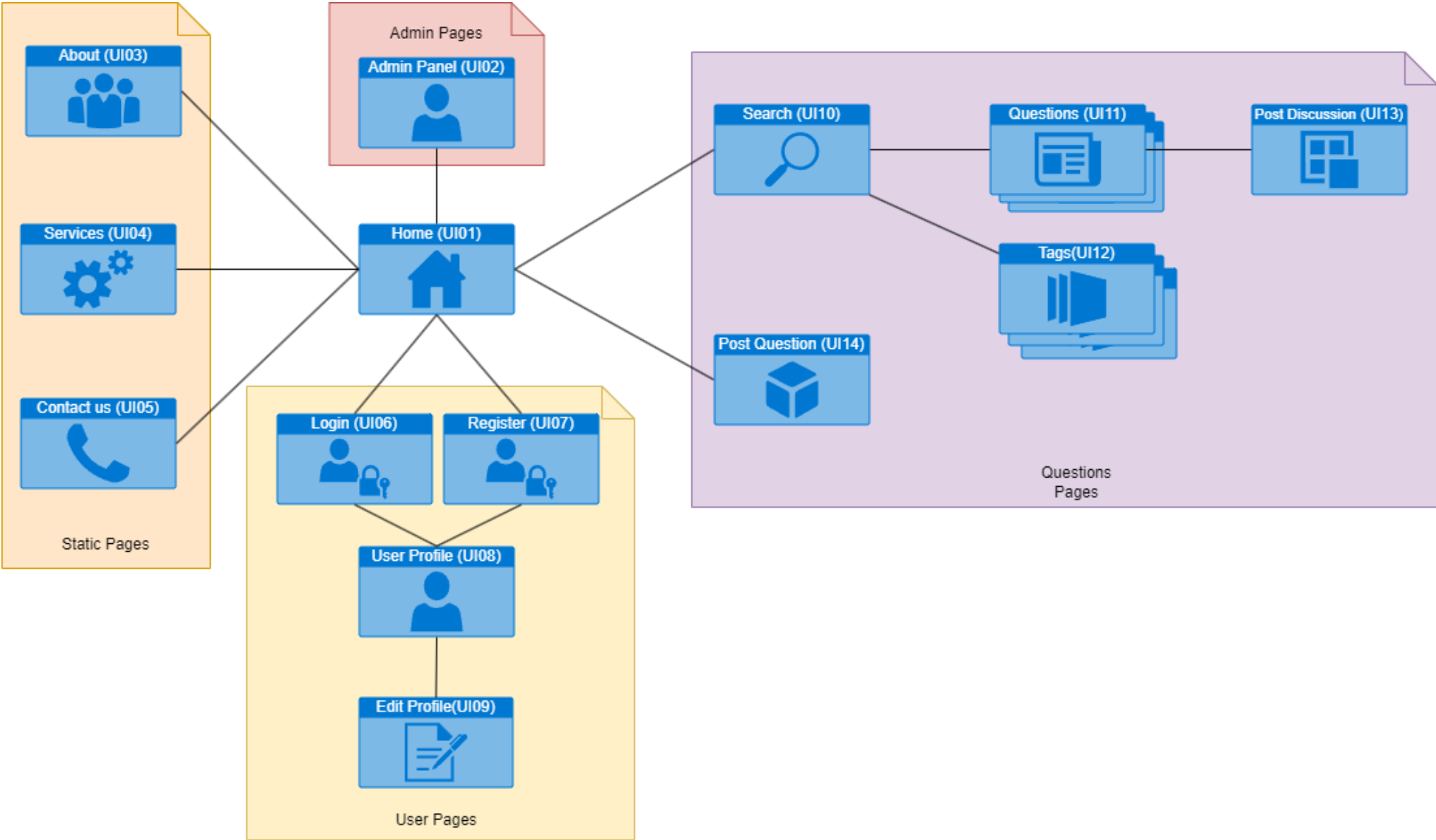


Figure 1: AskIT sitemap

2. Wireframes

This wireframes are used to describe layout ideas, content, and the overall page-level design. For the AskIT platform, the wireframes for the item Home page (UI01) and the user profile page (UI08) are presented in Figures 2 and 3, respectively.

UI01:Home

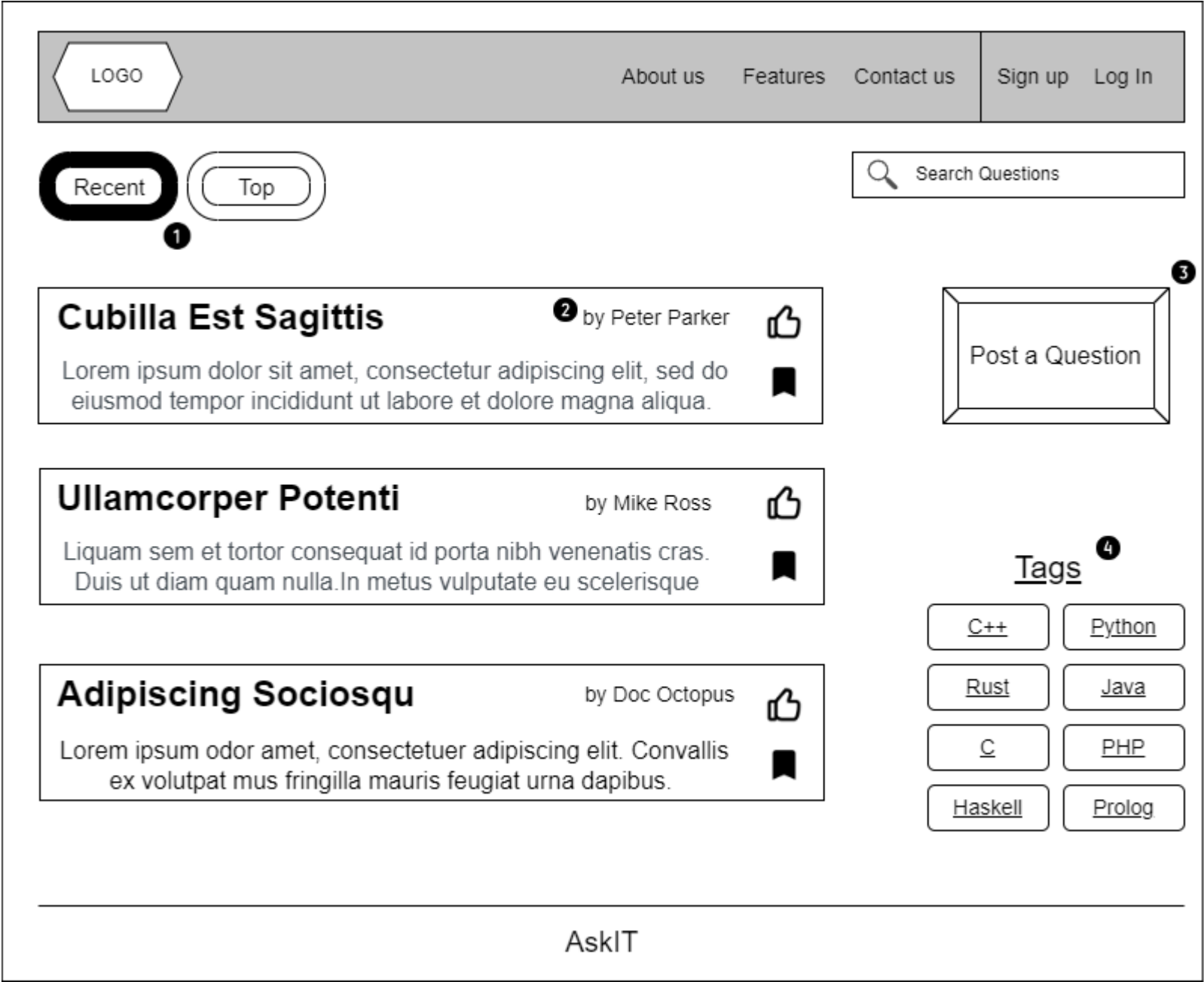


Figure 2: Home page wireframe

- 1. User can choose between Recent and Top posts
- 2. User that post the question
- 3. Direct access to post a question
- 4. Link for all the tags that exist in the platform, and for each tag presented

UI08:User Profile

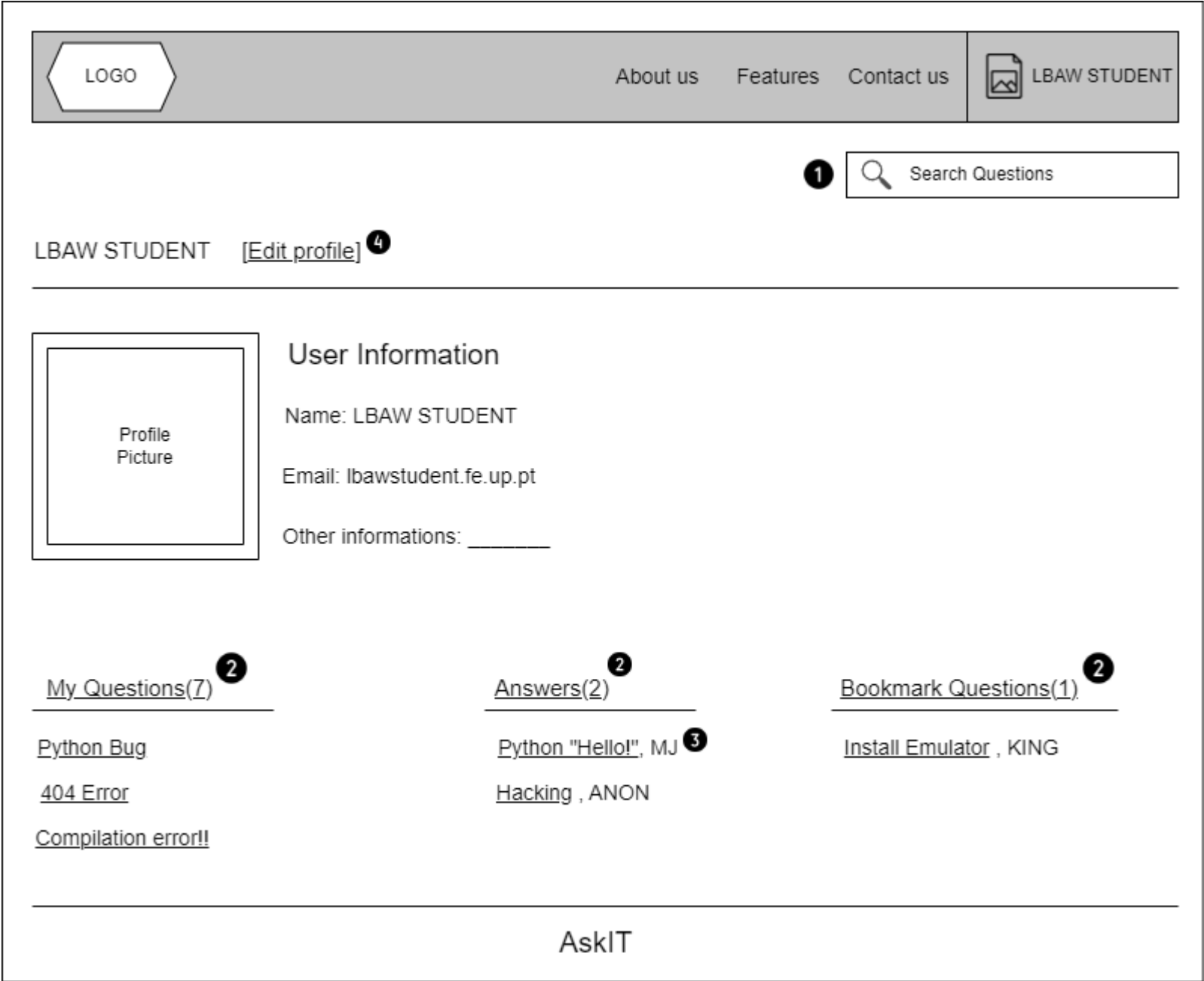


Figure 3: User profile page wireframe

- 1. Direct access to search feature
- 2. Direct link to full list of own questions, answers, and bookmark questions
- 3. Link to the post answered
- 4. Edit available for the profile owner

Revision history

Changes made to the first submission:

- 1. Project Vision
- 2. A1 (motivation, search)
- 3. A2 (user stories priority and granularity)

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